ARTIST PROTOCOL

Touch-up

Pull the original record first. Times in [brackets] are guides. Check your state and local health department rules.

SCREEN

Fully healed: at least [4–6] weeks since the session. Intake updated, ID checked.

ELIGIBILITY

Within [1–3] months? Hands, feet, fingers and face often excluded. Fee: [ ].

FIND THE CAUSE

Healing gap, blowout or aftercare? Sun damage and picking are not covered.

SET UP FIRST

☐ Original record pulled ☐ Barrier film on machine, cord, chair ☐ Nitrile gloves
☐ Sealed single-use cartridges ☐ Ink caps poured per client ☐ Sharps container

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Screen & review**	10 min	Pull the original record. Check healing, ID and any health changes.
2	**Assess & photos**	5 min	Mark gaps, light spots and uneven lines in good light. Before photos.
3	**Set up station**	10 min	Disinfect, barrier film on. Open cartridges in front of the client.
4	**Skin prep**	5 min	Shave with a single-use razor if needed, then antiseptic.
5	**Client approval**	5 min	Show each spot you will work. Note anything not covered.
6	**Line touch-up**	[ ] min	Match the original needle and depth. Fix gaps; don't retrace whole lines.
7	**Fill & color**	[ ] min	Same ink and lot where possible. Light passes on healed skin.
8	**Wipe & wrap**	5 min	Gentle wipe, after photos. Thin ointment, then wrap or small film.
9	**Aftercare review**	5 min	Short heal of about [1–2] weeks. Same care: no soaking, sun or picking.
10	**Breakdown**	10 min	Cartridges and razor to sharps; caps, film, towels to waste. Disinfect.
11	**Record**	5 min	Log inks, lots and areas on the original record. Note free or fee.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Gaps filled; color matches the healed work
- Before and after photos linked to the record
- Only target areas worked; minimal trauma
- Nothing reused; sharps never recapped

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Fainting or dizziness: stop, recline the client with legs raised. Water and sugar; resume only if fully well.
- Allergic reaction (hives, swelling): stop, remove the wrap. Breathing trouble or face swelling: call 911.
- Same spot heals patchy again: stop and ask about aftercare. Note skin type.
- Excessive bleeding: stop, firm pressure with clean gauze. Pause or reschedule; recheck blood thinners.
- Needle-stick: wash with soap and water, report it to the studio owner, follow your OSHA exposure plan.
- Signs of past infection or scarring: don't work over it. Refer to a doctor.

Always write an incident report, note the ink lot and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Original session date	Ink brand · color · lot #	Cartridges used	Machine · voltage
Areas touched up	**Free or fee [ ]**	**Cause noted**	**Time · initials**